

# *Website Search Engine Optimization Standards*



**GOA ELECTRONICS LIMITED**

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**REVISION HISTORY**

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**Audience:**

CTO, TL, SE / TSE , Testers, PM's

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## Before you start visit the following links

- ❖ Check the Broken links on the website  
<https://www.brokenlinkcheck.com/>  
<https://www.deadlinkchecker.com/>
- ❖ For identifying keywords that depict the website information can be checked on  
<https://neilpatel.com/ubersuggest/>
- ❖ Check Mobile compatibility of the website here  
<https://search.google.com/test/mobile-friendly>
- ❖ **SEO Checkup tool**  
There are various tools available online to check the performance, security level, and optimization etc. of the website. SEO Site Checkup tool allows you to improve on all the factors of the website. Simply open the URL as mentioned the below, enter your website name and click on Checkup button, It does a thorough analysis of all the pages and give you a solution to improve on the issues which will help in improving your website ranking on search engines.  
<https://seositecheckup.com/>  
<https://www.seobility.net/en/seocheck/>

## SEO Compliance Checkpoints

### 1. Title Tag

The title tag is the first HTML element that specifies what your web page is about. Title tags are important for SEO and visitors because they appear in the search engine results page (SERP) and in browser tabs.

For example, you can see the title tag in the browser tab header of this Templatemonster post.



The title element supports all browsers including Chrome, Firefox, and Safari. Always add your title tag in the <head> section of your site:



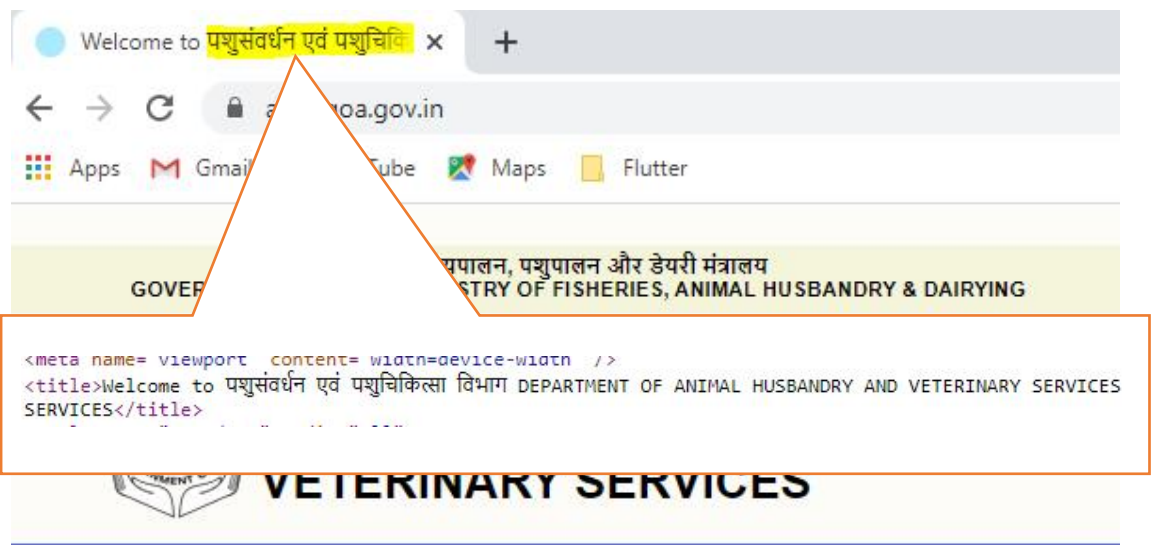
&lt;title&gt;

Insert Title Here

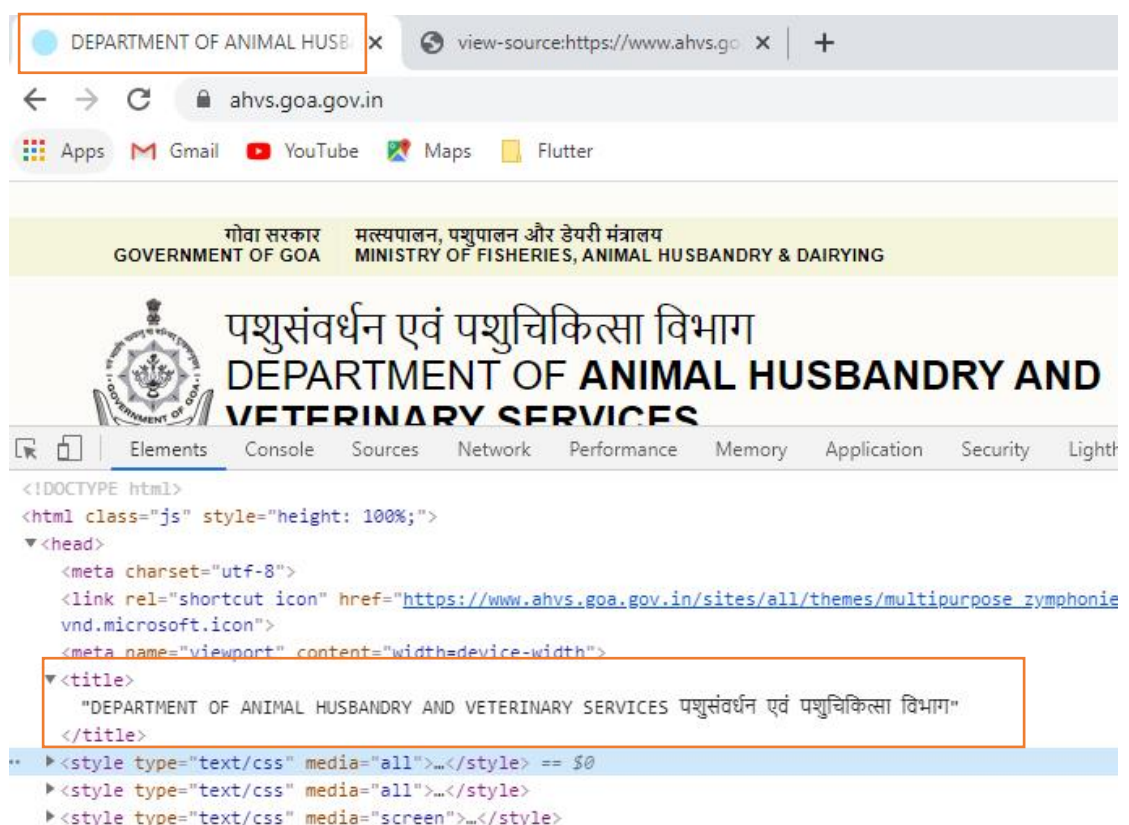
&lt;/title&gt;

Here are some good pointers for writing a title tag:

- Keep your title tag under **60** characters
- In case there is a Devnagari Text as Title and English text..then the English language text to be displayed before and then the devnagari text to be placed



The title in the above should be changed as below



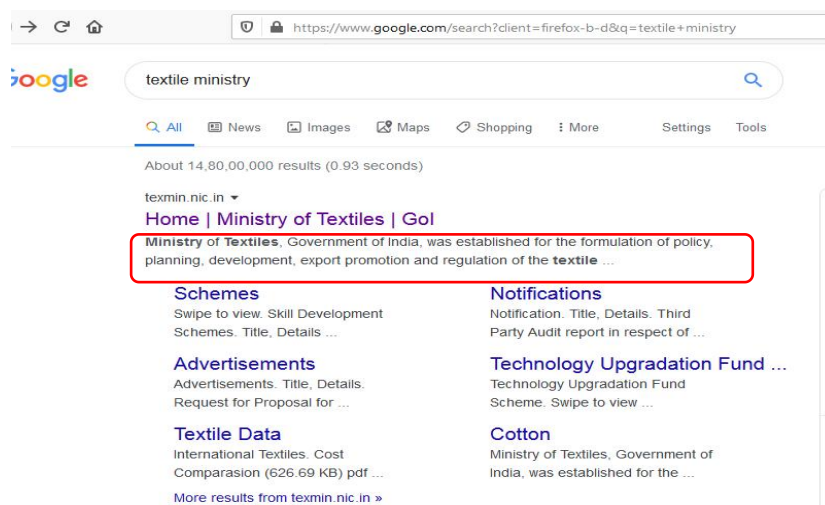


- Add words that indicate **what your content is about**, such as “How to,” “Review,” “Best,” “Tips,” “Top,” “Find,” or “Buy”
- Use long-tail keywords, or keywords with 4+ words, such as “is my site mobile-friendly” or “how to make a website mobile-friendly”
- Add **numbers** to your title, such as “9 HTML Tags That Will Improve SEO”
- Start your title tag with your **main targeted keyword**
- Don't stuff your keywords by writing anything like the following: “We sell custom humidors. Our custom humidors are handmade. If you’re thinking of buying a custom humidor, please contact our custom humidor specialists”
- Include a **unique** title tag on every page

## 2. Meta Description

A meta description is an HTML element that sums up the content on your web page. Search engines typically show the meta description in search results below your title tag.

Here’s an example of the meta description appearing on a search results page:



This is how you’d code a meta description like the one above:

```
<head>
  <meta name="description" content="This is meta description Sample. We can add up to 158.">
</head>
```

```
<meta name="format-detection" content="telephone=no" />

<meta name="title" content=" Ministry of Textiles | GoI">

<meta name="lang" content="en">

<meta name="MobileOptimized" content="width">

<meta http-equiv="X-UA-Compatible" content="IE=edge">
```



```
<meta name="keywords" content="Textile ministry, ministry of textile, smriti zubin iran, smriti irani, technology upgradation fund scheme, tufts, tufts audit, spelsgu, export promotion schemes, meis mai, mda, tmmt, technology mission on technical textiles, fic, sgdt, ipds, integrated process development scheme, jute technology mission.">
```

```
<meta name="description" content="Ministry of Textiles, Government of India, was established for the formulation of policy, planning, development, export promotion and regulation of the textile industry in India.">
```

```
<meta name="HandheldFriendly" content="true">
```

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1, maximum-scale=1">
```

Google does not use the meta description as a ranking signal. However, it still has a massive effect on your page's click-through rate (CTR) because it appears in search results and informs users what your page is about.

- Google's public search liaison, Danny Sullivan, mentioned that there is no fixed length for snippets.
- The average length of the description snippet field on desktop is around 160 characters
- Mobile characters for the search results of 130 characters.

Here's how to write a good description tag:

- Do not add duplicate meta descriptions.
- Add a clear call to action (CTA) in your descriptions like "apply today," "check out \_\_\_\_\_,"
- Add your targeted keywords in descriptions.
- Add any discounts or offers you have.

## 100 Sample Call To Action(CTA) words

|                    |                       |                        |
|--------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
| 1. Act Now         | 16. Come see our      | 30. Follow this        |
| 2. Add to your     | prices                | 31. Get a quote        |
| 3. Apply today     | 17. Compare prices    | 32. Get Free           |
| 4. Be sure to      | 18. Contact us        | 33. Get it here        |
| 5. Book now        | 19. Contact us today  | 34. Get More Info Here |
| 6. Buy and Save    | 20. Discover          | 35. Get the Best       |
| 7. Buy Now         | 21. Do not buy unless | 36. Get your           |
| 8. Call today      | 22. Don't forget to   | 37. Give a gift        |
| 9. Check our       | 23. Don't miss        | 38. How to             |
| 10. Check out      | 24. Don't wait        | 39. Hurry              |
| 11. Check this out | 25. Download now      | 40. Investigate        |
| 12. Choose your    | 26. Find Items        | 41. Join today         |
| 13. Click button   | 27. Find out more     | 42. Join us            |
| 14. Click for more | 28. Find savings      | 43. Learn more         |
| 15. Click Here     | 29. Find yours        | 44. Learn to           |



|     |                      |     |                  |      |                    |
|-----|----------------------|-----|------------------|------|--------------------|
| 45. | Look at              | 63. | Save on          | 82.  | Sign me up now     |
| 46. | Need more            | 64. | Save Today       | 83.  | Sign up            |
| 47. | No obligation to try | 65. | Save up to       | 84.  | Start now          |
| 48. | Now you can          | 66. | Save with        | 85.  | Start today        |
| 49. | Order Now            | 67. | Search for       | 86.  | Stock up           |
| 50. | Order Your           | 68. | Search Now       | 87.  | Submit             |
| 51. | Pay Less             | 69. | Search our       | 88.  | Take a closer look |
| 52. | Please see           | 70. | See deals        | 89.  | Take a look at     |
| 53. | Please view our      | 71. | See more         | 90.  | Take a tour        |
| 54. | Purchase             | 72. | See our coupon   | 91.  | Tour our           |
| 55. | Read reviews         | 73. | See our products | 92.  | Try it today       |
| 56. | Register             | 74. | See pricing      | 93.  | View all Products  |
| 57. | Request yours        | 75. | Send for         | 94.  | View features      |
|     | today                | 76. | Shop at          | 95.  | Visit our          |
| 58. | Research             | 77. | Shop low prices  | 96.  | Visit us at        |
| 59. | Respond by           | 78. | Shop now         | 97.  | Watch for          |
| 60. | Rush today           | 79. | Shop online      | 98.  | You might also try |
| 61. | Save Big             | 80. | Shop today       | 99.  | You might consider |
| 62. | Save Money           | 81. | Show price       | 100. | Yours for asking   |

---

### 3. Canonical Tag

A canonical tag is an HTML link tag with the attribute "rel=canonical."

It's used to indicate that there are other versions of this webpage. By implementing the canonical tag in the code, your website tells search engines that this URL is the main page and that the engines shouldn't index other pages.

Use the following syntax to add a canonical tag:

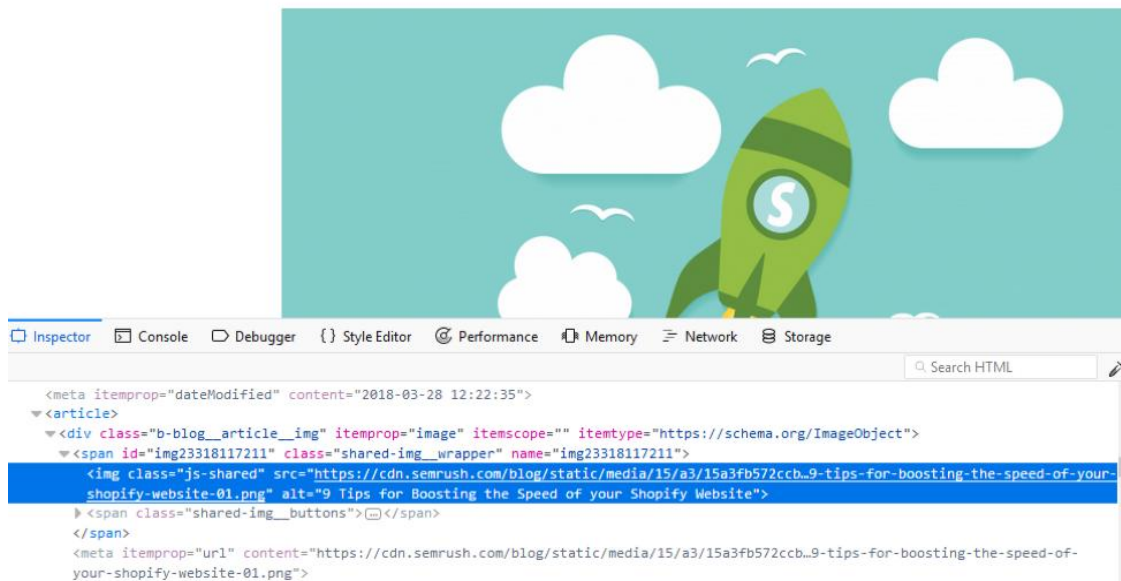
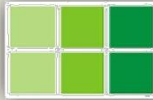
```
<link rel="canonical" href="http://example.com/" />
```

---

### 4. Alternative Text Tag

Search engines can't read images, which are a crucial part of many websites. Alternative text (alt text) is a way around that issue.

You should add proper alt text to images, such as the one below, so that search engines know how to interpret them.



That way, you can include inviting graphics on your website without damaging your SEO.

When creating alt text for your website, use the following syntax:

```

```

Here are some tips for your alt text tags:

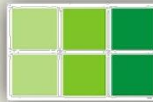
- Always use a proper description, and never stuff your keyword in this tag
- Use informative filenames
- Be clear and to the point
- Create an image sitemap
- Use 50-55 characters (up to 16 words) in the alt text
- Use an average or small file size for faster page loading speed – just don't compromise the image's resolution

## 5. Robots Meta Tag

The robots meta tag informs search engines which pages on your site should be indexed. This meta tag serves a similar purpose to robots.txt; it is generally used to prevent a search engine from indexing individual pages, while robots.txt will prevent it from indexing a whole site or section of a site.

The tag has four main values for the search engine crawlers:

- FOLLOW –The search engine crawler will follow all the links in that webpage
- INDEX –The search engine crawler will index the whole webpage



- NOFOLLOW – The search engine crawler will NOT follow the page and any links in that webpage
- NOINDEX – The search engine crawler will NOT index that webpage

Use the following syntax for your robots meta tag:

`<meta name="robots" content="noindex, nofollow">` --> Means not to index or not to follow this webpage.

`<meta name="robots" content="index, follow">`--> Means index and follow this webpage.

Place the robots meta tag in the <head> section of your webpage.

---

## 6. Open Graph Meta Tags and Twitter Cards

These tags make social media syncing easier.

Open graph meta tags promote integration between Facebook, LinkedIn, Google, and your website.

Here is a sample of how Open Graph tags look like in standard HTML:

```
<meta property="og:type" content="article" />
<meta property="og:title" content="TITLE OF YOUR POST OR PAGE" />
<meta property="og:description" content="DESCRIPTION OF PAGE CONTENT" />
<meta property="og:image" content="LINK TO THE IMAGE FILE" />
<meta property="og:url" content="PERMALINK" />
<meta property="og:site_name" content="SITE NAME" />
```

Twitter cards work in a similar way to Open Graph, except for Twitter.

Twitter will use these tags to enhance the display of your page when shared on their platform.

Here is a sample of How Twitter card look like in standard HTML:

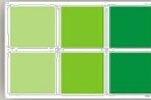
```
<meta name="twitter:title" content="TITLE OF POST OR PAGE">
<meta name="twitter:description" content="DESCRIPTION OF PAGE CONTENT">
<meta name="twitter:image" content="LINK TO IMAGE">
<meta name="twitter:site" content="@USERNAME">
<meta name="twitter:creator" content="@USERNAME">
```

---

## 7. Header Tags

You can use header tags to change font sizes and signify information hierarchy on a page.

The heading elements go from H1 to H6. H1 is the largest and most important level, and H6 is the smallest and least important.



```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h1>This is H1</h1>
<h2>This is H2</h2>
<h3>This is H3</h3>
<h4>This is H4</h4>
<h5>This is H5</h5>
<h6>This is H5</h6>

</body>
</html>
```

**This is H1**

**This is H2**

**This is H3**

**This is H4**

**This is H5**

**This is H5**

If you mark text with an H1 tag, you signify to search engines that it's the most important text on that page. H1 tag should be used only once on each page to signify the importance of the page to the crawler, H2 tags can be used maximum 10 times in a page.

## 8. Responsive Design Meta Tag

The final important meta tag is the responsive design meta tag, which is also called the viewport meta element. Viewport meta tags allow web designers to configure how a page scales and displays on any device.



**Without the viewport meta tag**



**With the viewport meta tag**

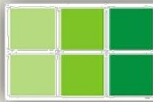
In the first image, the text is cramped and hard to read, and the image doesn't scale well. In the second, both the text and the image fit the dimensions of the screen.

You can find the viewport element in the head section of your web page.

Use the following syntax to add a responsive design meta tag:

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width,initial-scale=1.0">
```

There's one exception to the viewport meta tag rule: don't use it if your website pages are not responsive, as it will make the user experience worse. You can use this tool to check whether your site is responsive.



---

#### 9. Alternate Image text

Always add alternate text to images on the website and follow a steady naming convention for image file as well as alternate text. If any image file has a random name like “d11.jpg” then the name should be modified and renamed as per the content.

Ex. `src="img/Seal_of_Goa.png" class="sealofgoa" alt="Seal of Goa"`

This input is processed by the crawlers to understand the type of content available on the website.

---

#### 10. Plaintext emails and web reference

All the emails and web references mentioned on the website should be converted to plain text.

Ex. Website name `www.startupindia.gov.in` should be changed to `www[dot]startupindia[dot]gov[dot]in`

---

#### 11. Robots file

Create a robots.txt file and mention which crawlers can access your website contents for indexing. You can allow or disallow pages, files, and folders as mentioned below.

```
User-agent: *  
Disallow: /CSS/  
Disallow: /fonts/  
Disallow: /img/  
Disallow: /js/
```

---

#### 12. Google Analytics

Google Analytics is one of the most popular digital analytics software. It is Google's free web analytics service that allows you to analyze in-depth detail about the visitors on your website. It provides valuable insights that can help you to shape the success strategy of your business.

---

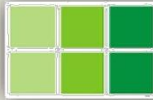
#### 13. Compression of files

Compress all the image, javascript, and css files to reduce page load time. The focus of the compression of images if any for better performance and loading time.

---

#### 14. Caching

Always check the page and image caching duration and limit the same to 7 days. These changes should be done in htaccess file. (This is done on Apache web server)



```
## EXPIRES CACHING ##  
<IfModule mod_expires.c>  
ExpiresActive On  
ExpiresByType image/jpg "access 1 week"  
ExpiresByType image/jpeg "access 1 week"  
ExpiresByType image/gif "access 1 week"  
ExpiresByType image/png "access 1 week"  
ExpiresByType text/css "access 1 month"  
ExpiresByType text/html "access 1 month"  
ExpiresByType application/pdf "access 1 month"  
ExpiresByType text/x-javascript "access 1 month"  
ExpiresByType application/x-shockwave-flash "access 1 month"  
ExpiresByType image/x-icon "access 1 year"  
ExpiresDefault "access 1 month"  
</IfModule>  
## EXPIRES CACHING ##
```

## 15. Sitemap of website

Always add a sitemap for a website which will help robots index your content more thoroughly and quickly.

## 16. Favicon Icon

Favicon Icon help a users remember your site while browsing through multiple URLs. With a favicon you seem to have a higher advantage over websites that do not when it comes to saving and keeping a website bookmark on the browser. Search engines such as Google has the Chrome browser for users through which they also deduct certain search ranking signals for sites bookmarked on the web. If there is no favicon to your site, you may lose out on the chance of being on a bookmarked list of a Chrome browser and hence indirectly lose out on a small but significant search ranking signal.

E.g. `<link rel="shortcut icon" href="www.example.com/favicon.ico">`

## 17. Inline CSS

For SEO, your page source code must download completely within 7 seconds. If it is slower than that for Googlebot, Google makes rankings worse for it. Hence don't make your homepage complicated with the use of Inline CSS.

It is a good practice to move all the inline CSS rules into an external file in order to make your page "lighter" in weight and decrease the code-to-text ratio.

- check the HTML code of your page and identify all style attributes



- for each style attribute found you must properly move all declarations in the external CSS file and remove the style attribute

18. **Domain Name:**

- Choose a domain name that states the subject being addressed to. E.g. Agriculture dept agri.goa.gov.in; animal husbandry ahvs.goa.gov.in, etc
- Avoid repeating words in URL. E.g. dmnggoa.goa.gov.in instead a better url could have been dmng.goa.gov.in or goadmng.gov.in or dmnggoa.gov.in
- The domains with **.goa.gov.in** extensions are issued by Dept of IT and can be issued in a days time and the Static IP to which they connect are maintained by DoIT.
- Domain names with **.gov.in** or **.nic.in** are issued by central registry of NIC through registry.gov.in portal
- The site should be configured for canonical urls. I.e. for website the url should always lead to a base url. E.g <https://www.goaonline.gov.in> or [www.goaonline.gov.in](http://www.goaonline.gov.in) or goaonline.gov.in or <https://goaonline.gov.in> should lead to <https://goaonline.gov.in>